

B13 EXCAVATION

Objectives

- (a) To set maximum acceptable extents of excavation which achieve the following objectives.
- (b) To minimise the impact of excavation on the natural environment, neighbouring properties, and streetscape.
- (c) To ensure the physical environment is preserved and enhanced through minimal site disturbance and the geotechnical stability of landfill and excavations.
- (d) To minimise cut and fill on sloping sites.
- (e) To encourage good quality internal environments including natural light and ventilation.
- (f) To prevent use of subterranean spaces as habitable rooms.
- (g) To prevent development exceeding the maximum car parking controls.
- (h) To ensure excavation does not adversely impact land stabilisation, ground water flows and vegetation.
- (i) To minimise structural risks to adjoining structures.

Controls

- (a) Excavation for basements will not be supported for dwelling house, attached dwelling, dual occupancy or semi-detached dwelling development, unless Council is satisfied that there is no alternative location on the site to accommodate parking and storage, the development satisfies the objectives of Part B13, and the basement:
 - (i) Has a maximum floor to ceiling height of 2.1m, except where the entry requires higher to meet Australian Standards,
 - (ii) Does not exceed one floor,
 - (iii) Will not contain any habitable rooms unless the room is at grade with external natural ground level along at least one side (refer to Figure 24), and
 - (iv) Has an area no greater than the area required to accommodate:
 - A maximum of 1 car parking space for dwellings with 1-2 bedrooms, or a maximum of 2 car parking spaces for dwellings with 3 or more bedrooms;
 - Waste storage for 3 x 140L bins per dwelling;
 - A plant room complying with control (b) of this part;
 - A maximum of 8 cubic metres of storage per dwelling; and
 - Minimum access requirements to the car parking and storage areas.
- (b) The maximum area permitted for a plant room in any development is the minimum required to meet Australian Standards, accommodate typical dimensions of equipment required and the associated circulation space to access the equipment for maintenance. DA plans should show the approximate location and size of equipment within the plant room.
- (c) Excavation should not add to the visual bulk and scale of the building.
- (d) Excavation should not result in the loss of naturally occurring sandstone. Where sandstone or natural rock are to be removed, opportunities for reuse on site should be considered (such as for front fencing or landscaping).